

Written Status Report CMSI 4072

Project Status Sheet Spring 2026

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Project: Sammy's Games: A Board and Card Game Platform

Date: April 11, 2026

Period Covered: March 25 – April 8

Accomplishments since last report:

After receiving feedback that Six Hands is a bit too complex for a daily game style, I decided to make a smaller version. Five Hands is a 5×5 variant of Six Hands, using the same core logic but with a simpler ruleset, just five orthogonally connected groups of five forming poker hands. Specific technical milestones include:

- **Five Hands Implementation:** Built the full game using the same BFS connectivity checker and hand evaluation engine as Six Hands, adapted for a 5×5 grid and five color groups. The shared logic meant the core was quick to port; most of the work was restructuring the grid dimensions and removing the sixth-hand toggle.
- **Daily Seed Parity:** Five Hands uses the same seed generation logic as Six Hands, ensuring the puzzle is consistent globally per calendar day.
- **Platform Integration:** Five Hands is now linked in the nav bar alongside Knockout, Knockout Bot, RPS, and Six Hands, making the platform feel like a cohesive product rather than a collection of isolated pages.
- **Code Cleanup:** Refactored shared logic between Five Hands and Six Hands (hand evaluator, BFS validator, color picker, card rendering) to reduce duplication across files.

Scheduled tasks to be done by next report:

- **Mobile Optimization:** Refine CSS Grid layouts and touch targets across all games, particularly Five Hands and Six Hands where the grids are widest (April 22).
- **Polish Pass:** Bug testing across all five pages with focus on edge cases in the hand evaluator (e.g., two Jokers in the same group) and any visual inconsistencies between games (April 22).
- **Third Game?:** Five Hands could count as a third game given it has relevant differences, though I'm still aiming to make a more unique third entry if I can. (April 22)

Noteworthy risks, concerns, or problems:

- **Concern: Code Duplication Across Game Files:** Five Hands and Six Hands currently share a lot of identical logic living in separate files. If a bug is found in the hand evaluator, it needs to be fixed in two places.

- **Mitigation Plan:** Consider extracting shared utilities into a single `gameUtils.js` module that both pages import, time permitting.

Current Status: ON TRACK Five Hands is complete and the platform adds another to its lineup of games. The remaining focus is polish, mobile responsiveness, and other potential user experience updates.